

**2025 Fall Annual Town Meeting
Kennedy Middle School Auditorium
October 21, 2025, First Session**

The first session of the 2025 Fall Town Meeting was called to order at 7:31 PM by Town Moderator, Jeffrey Alderson, who declared a quorum present. The Moderator welcomed residents, taxpayers, town officials, Town Meeting Members and interested parties to the first session of 2025 Fall Annual Town Meeting. The Moderator asked that all recently elected or appointed members of Town Meeting stand to take the oath of office to which two new members rose.

Rabbi Raysh Weiss of Temple Israel Natick delivered the invocation for the fall Town Meeting.

The Moderator asked the audience to stand for the Pledge of Allegiance and a moment of silence in recognition of all the men and women serving on our behalf throughout the world.

The Moderator introduced the officials present for the meeting: Andrew Ghobrial, Town Clerk; Todd Gillenwater, Finance Committee Chair; Cody Jacobs, Finance Committee Secretary; Karis North, Town Counsel; James Errickson, Town Administrator; and Bruce Evans, Select Board Chair. Maya Allen will operate the slides and Jeff Horan, a representative from Option Technologies, will operate the electronic voting system.

The Moderator reviewed the seating arrangement of the auditorium and the rules for this Town Meeting. The proceedings of Town Meetings shall be governed by *Town Meeting Time, third edition*, the Town of Natick Home Rule Charter, the Natick Bylaws and the General Laws of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts. The Moderator reviewed the general rules and procedures of Town Meeting. He indicated that all residents and taxpayers of the town, town officers and employees, whether or not residents, have the same right to speak as Town Meeting Members; however they do not have the right to submit motions for consideration at Town Meeting, nor vote on any matter before Town Meeting. Non-residents may only speak at Town Meeting after approval by Town Meeting Members. No person shall speak upon any debatable motion more than once when any other person desires to be heard, nor more than twice on the same question without permission of Town Meeting; and no person shall speak more than five (5) minutes at one time without permission of Town Meeting. All motions offered for the consideration of Town Meeting shall be in writing if required by the Moderator; and all motions involving the expenditure of money shall be in writing when required by any Town Meeting Member. Written motions shall be presented to the Moderator on prescribed forms.

Consistent with the Natick Bylaws, once a member is recognized, it has been the practice of Town Meeting Members to first ask a question(s), then propose a motion and/or debate the highest-ranking motion. Once a speaker is called upon by the moderator, the speaker's time will begin. Time expended asking questions will be considered part of the speaker's time, pursuant to the Natick Bylaws. Responses to the speaker's question will not be considered part of the speaker's requisite time. Each speaker will be limited to three questions, whether they are stated singularly or in a compound question, such will be responded to at the direction of the

Moderator. Motions shall be made and have precedence as listed in the table entitled "Precedence of Motions," found in the Natick Bylaws, the Town Meeting Member Handbook and *Town Meeting Time, third edition*. The motion for the previous question shall not be entertained by the Moderator if three or more persons are seeking recognition, who have not previously spoken to the question.

Any person having a monetary or equitable interest in any matter under discussion at a Town Meeting, and any person employed by another having such an interest, shall disclose the fact of his/her interest or employment before speaking on the matter.

Regarding advance communications of amendments or alternate motions which may be presented at Town Meeting, the Moderator and the Clerk must receive draft motions in advance; 48 hours before Town Meeting is preferred to deliberate such. In addition, with complex motions, motions need to be provided via a document file format (Word or Google Docs), so that motions may be displayed on the stage screen. Finally, the Moderator, must accept as "in order" or rule "out of order" all motions. Therefore, complex motions that have not been reviewed by the Moderator and the Clerk (and in some cases town counsel) will likely cause a delay at Town Meeting, and/or may be - unilaterally ordered or - suggested that you folks postpone consideration of the current question for technical review.

These rules were accepted without objection.

A motion to waive readings of the text passes by a majority hand vote.

The Moderator read the numbers of the articles included in the consent agenda. There was one hold for Article 2. Moved by Rich Sidney, seconded by Robert Awkward that the Town take Articles 1, 3, 5, 6, 7, 8, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 27, 30 and 32 out of order and that they be "Passed by Consent" in accordance with the motion published in the Consent Agenda distributed in the Finance Committee Book of Recommendations.

Procedural Motions Passed:

1. Moved by Jaymin Patel to consider Article 10 as the first order of business tonight, October 21st.
2. Moved Rich Sidney to advance Article 12 to be considered immediately preceding Article 11.
3. Moved by David Krentzman to postpone consideration of Article 28 to the first order of business on October 28th.
4. Moved by Jonathan Freedman postpone consideration of Article 29 to the second order of business on October 28th.
5. Moved by Donna McKenzie to postpone consideration of Article 33 to the first order of business on October 23rd.

ARTICLE 1: Committee Article

To see if the Town will vote to hear and discuss the reports of town officers, boards, and committees; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	No Action
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/30/2025

MOTION (Requires majority vote)

Moved No Action

ARTICLE 3: Rescind Authorized, Unissued Debt

To see if the Town will vote to rescind the authorization for unissued debt that has been determined is no longer needed for the completion of various projects; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/25/2025

MOTION (Requires majority vote)

Move that the Town vote to rescind authorized unissued debt for capital projects that have been determined are no longer needed for the completion of the following projects:

TM Article	Date of Vote	Amount Appropriated	Amount Rescinded	Project
2024 SATM Art. 12, Motion A Item 11	5/2/2024	\$780,000.00	\$680,000.00	Building HVAC Upgrades

Total Amount Rescinded:

\$680,000.00

ARTICLE 5: Stabilization Funds

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Stabilization Fund established under Article 22 of 1961 Annual Town Meeting, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended;

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Operational Stabilization Fund established under Article 4 of the 2011 Spring Annual Town Meeting, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended;

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the Other Post-Employment Benefits Liability Trust Fund established under Article 15 of the 2017 Spring Annual Town Meeting pursuant to the provisions of Chapter 32B, Section 20 of the General Laws as amended by section 15 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016;

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Capital Stabilization Fund established under Article 2 of the 2010 Fall Annual Town Meeting, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/25/2025

MOTION (Requires a majority vote)

Move that the Town vote to appropriate \$934,000 from FY2026 Certified New Growth for the purpose of supplementing the Town's Stabilization Funds as follows:

\$400,807 from New Growth for Fiscal Year 2026 for the purpose of supplementing the Operational/Rainy Day Stabilization Fund established under Article 4 of the 2011 Spring Annual Town Meeting as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended.

\$533,193 from New Growth for Fiscal Year 2026 for the purpose of supplementing the Capital Stabilization Fund established by the vote of Article 2 of the 2010 Fall Annual Town Meeting, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended.

ARTICLE 6: PEG Access and Cable Related Fund

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to appropriate from the PEG Access and Cable Related Fund, established under Article 1 of the 2019 Special Town Meeting #1 as authorized by Chapter 44, Section 53F ³/₄ of the General Laws, as amended, to fund PEG access programming, as well as certain other municipal cable related expenses; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/25/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move that the Town vote to appropriate from the PEG Access and Cable Related Fund, established by vote of the 2019 Special Town Meeting #1, Article 1, as authorized by Chapter 44, Section 53F 3/4 of the General Laws, as amended, the sum of \$310,059.98 to fund PEG access programming.

ARTICLE 7: Collective Bargaining

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds, or otherwise provide, to implement any Collective Bargaining Agreements between the Town Natick and any recognized bargaining units of the Town; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/25/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move that the Town vote to appropriate the total sum of \$189,767.00 from the Select Board Expenses, as approved by vote of the 2025 Spring Annual Town Meeting, Article 3 Motion A, for the implementation of the Terms of the Agreements reached between the Town and the following collective bargaining units:

New England Police Benevolent Association, AFL-CIO, Local 82 - Superior Officers;

The Natick Patrol Officers' Association.

For payment of wages effective July 1, 2025 through June 30, 2026.

The total sum of \$189,767.00 shall be transferred to the following departmental line items as indicated below to supplement appropriations that were previously appropriated at the 2025 Spring Annual Town Meeting:

Police – Article 3 – Motion A – Salaries - \$189,767.00.

ARTICLE 8: Transfer of Unexpended Bond Proceeds

To see if the Town will authorize the transfer of unexpended proceeds from amounts previously borrowed to pay costs of various capital projects, which projects are now complete, and for which such funds are no longer needed, to pay costs of one or more capital projects; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	No Action
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/25/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move No Action

ARTICLE 13: Acceptance of MGL Chapter 41, Section 110A

To see if the Town will vote to accept the provisions of Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 41 Section 110A; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	8-0-4
	DATE VOTED:	9/11/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move that the Town accept the provisions of Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 41 Section 110A.

ARTICLE 14: AMEND Bylaw Article 50, Section 16.15: Dog License and Kennel License Fee

To see if the Town will Amend Bylaw Article 50, Section 16.15 Dog License and Kennel License Fees; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	12-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/11/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move that the Town vote to delete the text of Article 50, section 16.15 of the By-Law and replace it with the following:

16:15 Dog License and Kennel License Fees

Fees for un-neutered male, un-spayed female dogs, neutered male, spayed female dogs and all kennels under this section shall be adopted by the Select Board subsequent to a Public Hearing.

ARTICLE 15: Establishment of a Hybrid Town Meeting Committee

To see what action(s) the Town will take to establish a Hybrid Town Meeting Committee, in accordance with Section 2-11 (e) of the Town of Natick Home Rule Charter, to study and recommend a framework for conducting hybrid town meetings, to determine how the committee shall be constituted, to see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds, or otherwise provide for the operation of the committee; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/30/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move:

WHEREAS, the Town of Natick recognizes the importance of maximizing voter participation and engagement in its democratic processes;

WHEREAS, the advent of technology offers new opportunities to facilitate broader access to Town Meeting proceedings while maintaining the integrity and deliberative nature of the meeting;

WHEREAS, it is deemed prudent to establish a committee to thoroughly research, analyze, and propose a comprehensive plan for the implementation of hybrid town meetings in Natick.

Therefore, it is hereby moved that the Town of Natick establish a committee to be known as the "Hybrid Town Meeting Committee" with the following charter:

1. **Purpose:** The Hybrid Town Meeting Committee shall be charged with the responsibility of studying and recommending a comprehensive framework for the conduct of hybrid town meetings in Natick, including but not limited to:
 - Reviewing the hybrid meeting practices currently in place at Representative Town Meetings in Massachusetts.
 - Evaluating various technological platforms and solutions for remote participation.
 - Developing protocols and procedures to ensure secure and verifiable remote voting.

- Addressing issues related to accessibility and equity for all participants, regardless of their technological capabilities.
- Proposing amendments to existing bylaws or the Town Charter as necessary to facilitate hybrid meetings.
- Considering the logistical and financial implications of implementing hybrid meetings.
- Recommending best practices for maintaining the decorum and deliberative nature of Town Meeting in a hybrid format.

2. **Composition:** The Hybrid Town Meeting Committee shall consist of nine (9) members, appointed as follows:

Eight (8) Town Meeting members appointed by the Moderator.

One (1) member representing Natick Pegasus appointed by the Moderator.

3. **Reporting:** The Hybrid Town Meeting Committee shall submit its recommendations to the Select Board and Town Meeting at the 2026 Spring Annual Town Meeting. The report shall include a detailed proposal for the implementation of hybrid town meetings, including any proposed bylaw amendments or other necessary actions.
4. **Funding:** The Town shall appropriate the sum of \$10,000 from FY 2026 State Aid to support the work of the Hybrid Town Meeting Committee, including but not limited to, the procurement of legal counsel, expert consultations, technological assessments, and public outreach efforts.

Sunset Clause: Unless otherwise extended by a vote of Town Meeting, the Hybrid Town Meeting Committee shall cease to exist upon the submission of its final report or by June 30, 2026, whichever comes first.

ARTICLE 16: Street Acceptance – Jennifer Circle

To see if the Town will vote to accept Jennifer Circle as a public way, and any appurtenant easements thereto, as laid out by the Select Board and as shown on a plan or plans on file at the Department of Public Works and the Office of the Town Clerk; To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board to acquire by gift, purchase, eminent domain or otherwise, easements in any land necessary for laying out and acceptance of Jennifer Circle, and any appurtenant drainage, utility or other easements related to said Jennifer Circle and/or accept grants thereof; and, further, to authorize the Select Board and other applicable Town of Natick boards and personnel to take all related actions necessary or appropriate to accomplish the purposes of this article; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	11-0-1
	DATE VOTED:	9/11/2025

MOTION (Requires a 2/3rds Vote)

Move that the Town accept JENNIFER CIRCLE as a public way, and any appurtenant easements thereto, as laid out as shown on a plan entitled “HAWTHORNE VILLAGE“ dated February 20, 1990 revised 9/10/1990, prepared by McCarthy & Sullivan Engineering Inc.; and further that the Town authorize the Select Board to acquire by gift, purchase, eminent domain or otherwise, easements in any land necessary for laying out and acceptance of JENNIFER CIRCLE, and any appurtenant drainage, utility or other easements related to said JENNIFER CIRCLE and/or to accept grants thereof; and further to authorize the Select Board and other Applicable Town of Natick Boards and personnel to take all related actions necessary or appropriate to accomplish the purposes of this article; Meaning and intending to accept JENNIFER CIRCLE, such that the entirety of this named road is accepted by the Town as a public way.

ARTICLE 17: Street Acceptance - Graystone Lane

To see if the Town will vote to accept Graystone Lane as a public way, and any appurtenant easements thereto, as laid out by the Select Board and as shown on a plan or plans on file at the Department of Public Works and the Office of the Town Clerk; To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board to acquire by gift, purchase, eminent domain or otherwise, easements in any land necessary for laying out and acceptance of Graystone Lane , and any appurtenant drainage, utility or other easements related to said Graystone Lane and/or accept grants thereof; and, further, to authorize the Select Board and other applicable Town of Natick boards and personnel to take all related actions necessary or appropriate to accomplish the purposes of this article; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	12-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/11/2025

MOTION (Requires a 2/3rds Vote)

Move that the Town accept GRAYSTONE LANE as a public way, and any appurtenant easements thereto, as laid out as shown on a plan entitled “Plan of Acceptance of Graystone

Lane and Municipal Easements“ dated October 5, 2023, prepared by Bruce Saluk and Associates, Inc.; and further that the Town authorize the Select Board to acquire by gift, purchase, eminent domain or otherwise, easements in any land necessary for laying out and acceptance of Graystone Lane, and any appurtenant drainage, utility or other easements related to said Graystone Lane and/or to accept grants thereof; and further to authorize the Select Board and other Applicable Town of Natick Boards and personnel to take all related actions necessary or appropriate to accomplish the purposes of this article; Meaning and intending to accept Graystone Lane, such that the entirety of this named road is accepted by the Town as a public way.

ARTICLE 18: Street Acceptance - Boden Lane

To see if the Town will vote to (re)accept a portion of Boden Lane as a public way, and any appurtenant easements thereto, as laid out by the Select Board and shown on a plan or plans on file at the Department of Public Works and the Office of the Town Clerk; To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board to acquire by gift, purchase, eminent domain or otherwise, easements in any land necessary for laying out and to (re)accept a portion of Boden Lane, and any appurtenant drainage, utility or other easements related to said portion of Boden Lane and/or accept grants thereof; and, further, to authorize the Select Board and other applicable Town of Natick boards and personnel to take all related actions necessary or appropriate to accomplish the purposes of this article; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	No Action
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	12-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/11/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move NO ACTION

ARTICLE 19: Establish and Authorize Revolving Fund for Land Disturbance and Stormwater Management

To see if the Town will vote to amend Article 41A of the General Bylaws of the Town by adding a new section to establish and authorize the following revolving fund to utilize monies received through user fees and donations to fund costs associated with land disturbance and stormwater management programs and services, as provided for under Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 44, section 53E1/2; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/16/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move that the Town vote, pursuant to Chapter 44, Section 53E1/2 of the Massachusetts General Laws, to establish a Stormwater Management Revolving Fund, in order to utilize monies received through filing fees associated with Art 79A Stormwater Management and Erosion Control Bylaw; by amending article 41A of the Natick Town Bylaws to include a new section 18 – entitled “Stormwater Fund.”

ARTICLE 27: Community Preservation Funds: General Appropriation of Community Preservation Funds

To see if the Town will vote to appropriate from the Community Preservation Fund annual revenues in the amounts identified by the Community Preservation Committee in the amount equal to ten percent for each of the following CPA categories, which include Community (Affordable) Housing, Parks and Open Space, and Historic Preservation; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	No Action
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/16/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move NO ACTION

ARTICLE 30: Charter and By-law Review Committee Report and Extension

To see what action the Town will take to hear a report of the Charter and By-law Review Committee,

To see what action the Town Meeting will take to extend or to revise the term of the Charter and By-law Review Committee,

To see what action the Town Meeting will take to appropriate funds to continue work with special legal counsel and to authorize, if necessary, the Charter and By-law Review Committee to use such counsel; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/16/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Move that the town vote to hear a report of the Charter and Bylaw Review Committee.

ARTICLE 32: Changes in Town Meeting Time and Town By-Laws

To see what action the Town will take to amend or to change:

1) Section 1 Rules of Procedure of Article 3 Procedure at Town Meetings of the Town By-Laws to change the title and authorship reference to “Town Meeting Time, A Handbook of Parliamentary Law, 4th Edition” (the 4th Edition) or to a more or the most recent edition of Town Meeting Time updated by the Massachusetts Moderators Association;

2) Section 1 Rules of Procedure of Article 3 Procedure at Town Meetings to specify whether references to Town Meeting Time shall automatically refer to the most recent edition of Town Meeting Time or to provide that such versions, if any, subsequent to the 4th Edition, must be specifically named and or adopted by Town Meeting vote;

3) Other sections or Articles in the Town Bylaws provided such amendments or changes are directly related or responsive to changes in the 4th Edition that are i) identified, ii) noticed, iii) highlighted and/or contained within a 4th Edition chapter or section that is listed in either a) the “Town Meeting Time 4th Edition Appendix C: Mapping of 3rd Edition to 4th Edition Sections” or b) the “Editorial Notes on Town Meeting Time 4th Edition” as such documents are published by the Massachusetts Moderators Association with a copy of each document placed on file with the Town Clerk of Natick;

(For convenience only, copies of documents referred to in a) and b) above may also be found at <https://massmoderators.org/tmt4/> under https://drive.google.com/file/d/1qm1aekuPTpyyCXs_c5EkyIk79UrKaQ1j/view and <https://drive.google.com/file/d/13ZOaF7J0SVqogsdywFpODwXBdkXftGUM/view> as long as such links are maintained by the Massachusetts Moderators Association. For record copy for this warrant article, please see copy on file with Town Clerk of Natick.)

For convenience only, a copy of the 4th Edition and the 3rd Edition of Town Meeting Time has been ordered and will be placed on file with the Town Clerk of Natick when the copy arrives. For further convenience only, copies of the 4th Edition may be purchased from the

Massachusetts Moderators Association (<https://massmoderators.org>). Also, for convenience only, previous editions of Town Meeting Time might be accessed, subject to availability, through the Minuteman Library Network. or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	All Motions: Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	All Motions: 13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/16/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Motion A

“Move that the Town vote to amend Section 2 Motions in Writing of Article of Article 3 of the Bylaws by inserting the words “require a second when” after the words “All motions” and before the words “offered for” in the first sentence and by inserting the word “and” after the words “Town Meeting” and before the words “shall be” in the first sentence so that said Section 2 now reads:

Section 2 Motions in Writing

All motions require a second when offered for the consideration of the Town Meeting and shall be in writing if required by the Moderator; and all motions involving the expenditure of money shall be in writing when required by any Town Meeting Member.”

End of Motion A

Motion B

“Move that the Town vote to amend Section 1 Rules of Procedure of Article 3 of the bylaws by adding the following words to the beginning of the second paragraph of said Section 1:

“In addition to any statutory requirements for public hearings in advance of consideration of articles by Representative Town Meeting, the public hearing held by the Finance Committee on all matters of business within the warrant for any town meeting pursuant to Article 23 Section 4 of these bylaws also constitutes a required mandatory condition precedent to consideration by Representative Town Meeting. When the requirement of a mandatory condition precedent has not met, the Moderator should rule that the motion is not properly before the meeting and that no vote should be taken except as otherwise provided in this Section 1. When mandatory conditions precedent have not been met, allowable motions are postponement to a time certain or no action.” and by inserting the words

“In addition,” before the words “The Representative Town Meeting” in the last sentence of the current text of said second paragraph and changing the “T” in the word “The” of said sentence to lower case so that the second paragraph of Section 1 now reads:

“In addition to any statutory requirements for public hearings in advance of consideration of articles by Representative Town Meeting, the public hearing held by the Finance Committee on all matters of business within the warrant for any town meeting pursuant to Article 23 Section 4 of these bylaws also constitutes a required mandatory condition precedent to consideration by Representative Town Meeting. When the requirement of a mandatory condition precedent has not met, the Moderator should rule that the motion is not properly before the meeting and that no vote should be taken except as otherwise provided in this Section 1. When mandatory conditions precedent have not been met, allowable motions under these bylaws are ‘postponement to a time certain’ or ‘no action’. In addition, the Representative Town Meeting may, by a 2/3rds vote, waive any requirement in the bylaws for a public hearing, unless required by statute or the Town Charter, on specified or particular matters of business included within the articles of any Town Meeting.”

End of Motion B

Motion C

“Move that the Town vote to amend Section 1 Rules of Procedure of Article 3 of the Bylaws by adding a new third paragraph to Section 1 Rules of Procedure as follows:

The motion to dissolve Representative Town Meeting is not in order as long as any article in the warrant remains undisposed of.”

End of Motion C.

Motion D

“Move that the Town vote to amend the first paragraph of Section 1 Rules of Procedure of Article 3 of the Bylaws by deleting the words “the most recent edition of ‘Town Meeting Time’ by Johnson, Trustman, and Wadsworth” and inserting the words “ Town Meeting Time, A Handbook of Parliamentary Law, 4th Edition published by the Massachusetts Moderators Association” so that the first paragraph of said Section now reads:

Section 1 Rules of Procedure

The proceedings of Town Meetings shall be governed by such rules of practice as are clearly set out in “Town Meeting Time, A Handbook of Parliamentary Law, 4th Edition” published by the Massachusetts Moderators Association except as modified by law or by the following sections. In the event that “Town Meeting Time” does not clearly indicate a single course of action, the ruling of the Moderator shall prevail.”

End of Motion D.

The consent agenda passed by a majority vote (106/2/4).

ARTICLE 10: Appropriation for Memorial Elementary School Feasibility Study

To see if the Town will vote to appropriate, borrow or transfer from available funds, an amount of money to be expended under the direction of the School Building Committee for the Memorial Elementary School building project, currently located at 107 Eliot Street, Natick, Massachusetts, for which feasibility study the Town may be eligible for a grant from the Massachusetts School Building Authority. The MSBA's grant program is a non-entitlement, discretionary program based on need, as determined by the MSBA, and any costs the Town incurs in connection with the feasibility study in excess of any grant approved by and received from the MSBA shall be the sole responsibility of the Town; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/30/2025

MOTION (Requires a 2/3rds Vote)

Moved by Cody Jacobs, seconded by Todd Gillenwater that the Town of Natick appropriate the amount of Two Million Six Hundred Thousand (\$2,600,000) Dollars for the purpose of paying costs to conduct a feasibility study for the Memorial Elementary School building project, currently located at 107 Eliot Street, Natick, Massachusetts, including the payment of all costs incidental or related thereto, and for which the Town of Natick may be eligible for a grant from the Massachusetts School Building Authority ("MSBA"), said amount to be expended under the direction of the School Building Committee. To meet this appropriation the Select Board is authorized to borrow said amount

under and pursuant to M.G.L. Chapter 44, or pursuant to any other enabling authority. The Town of Natick acknowledges that the MSBA's grant program is a non-entitlement, discretionary program based on need, as determined by the MSBA, and any costs the Town of Natick incurs in excess of any grant approved by and received from the MSBA shall be the sole responsibility of the Town of Natick, and that the amount of borrowing authorized pursuant to this vote shall be reduced by any grant amount set forth in the Feasibility Study

Agreement that may be executed between the Town of Natick and the MSBA.

The motion under Article 10 passed by a 2/3rds vote (111/6/0). Superintendent of Schools Melissa Spash spoke on this article.

ARTICLE 2: FY 2026 Omnibus Budget

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the operation of the government of the Town of Natick, including debt and interest, during Fiscal Year 2026 (July 1, 2025 through June 30, 2026);

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the maintenance and operation of the Morse Institute Library and the Bacon Free Library for Fiscal Year 2026 (July 1, 2025 through June 30, 2026); or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	No Action
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/25/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Moved No Action by Cody Jacobs, seconded by Todd Gillenwater.

The motion under Article 2 passed by a majority vote (110/2/4).

ARTICLE 4: Unpaid Bills

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds, or otherwise provide for the payment of unpaid bills of previous years, incurred by the departments, boards and officers of the Town of Natick; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Favorable
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	13-0-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/25/2025

MOTION (Requires a 4/5ths Vote)

Moved by Cody Jacobs, seconded by Todd Gillenwater that the Town vote to appropriate from FY 2026 State Aid the sum of \$59,907.00 for the purpose of paying the following unpaid bills from prior fiscal years:

Inv	Department	Vendor	Invoice Date	Amount
1	Community Services	Amazon	04/01/25	\$916.79
2	Community Services	Amazon	06/01/25	\$717.78
3	Department of Public Work	Amazon	05/01/25	\$180.43
4	Department of Public Work	Amazon	05/01/25	\$82.30

5	Department of Public Work	Amazon	05/01/25	\$489.25
6	Department of Public Work	Amazon	05/01/25	\$310.00
7	Department of Public Work	Amazon	05/01/25	\$967.44
8	Department of Public Work	Brightly	04/28/25	\$33,980.55
9	Department of Public Work	Keys North Atlantic	06/05/25	\$6,450.00
10	Department of Public Work	Power Options	01/30/25	\$6,250.00
11	Human Resources - Benefits	BPAS	04/25/25	\$25.00
12	Human Resources - Benefits	BPAS	04/25/25	\$25.00
13	Human Resources - Benefits	Sentinel Group	07/08/25	\$769.30
14	Human Resources - Benefits	Sentinel Group	06/05/25	\$769.30
15	Information Technology	Security 101 – serviced 12/24	08/04/25	\$1,125.00
16	Park & Recreation	Amazon	04/01/25	\$810.15
17	Sassamon Golf Course	Prestige Flag	06/17/25	\$793.99
18	Town Administrator	Deductible Recovery Group	06/18/25	\$3,805.78
19	Town Administrator	Gannett New England	05/31/25	\$201.72
20	Natick Public Schools	Amazon	04/07/25	\$100.64
21	Natick Public Schools	Learning Center for the Deaf	03/31/24	\$220.00
22	Natick Public Schools	MA Assoc. of School Superintendents, Inc.	02/28/25	\$150.00
23	Natick Public Schools	Phonak	12/27/24	\$766.58
TOTAL				\$59,907.00

The motion under Article 4 passed by a 4/5th vote (116/1/1).

ARTICLE 9: Capital Equipment and Improvement

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds, borrow or otherwise provide to implement a Capital Improvement Program as may be required for capital equipment for the various departments of the Town of Natick; to protect the physical infrastructure of the Town of Natick, to add new physical infrastructure, or to improve community assets; and further to determine whether this appropriation shall be raised by borrowing or otherwise; or otherwise act thereon.

MOTIONS (Requires 2/3rds Majority):

Motion A

Moved by Cody Jacobs, seconded by Todd Gillenwater that the Town vote to appropriate the sum of \$7,605,000 to be expended as follows:

Under the direction of the Fire Department for the purpose of:

- Fire Engine

Under the direction of the Public Works Department for the purpose of:

- Multi-Wheel Sander

Under the direction of the Public Works Department (Water/Sewer) for the purpose of:

- Sewer Pump Station Rehabilitation and Replacement
- Water Meter Replacement
- Water Main Rehabilitation and Replacement

all individually shown as items 1 through 5 in Table A below, and that to meet this appropriation the Treasurer with the approval of the Select Board is authorized to borrow \$7,605,000 under Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 44, Section 7, as amended, or any other enabling authority and to issue bonds or notes of the Town therefor aggregating not more than \$7,605,000 in principal amount and that the Town Administrator, with the approval of the Select Board, is authorized to take any action necessary to carry out this program, and further, that any premium received by the Town upon the sale of any bonds or notes approved by this vote, less any such premium applied to the payment of the costs of issuance of such bonds or notes, may be applied to the payment of costs approved by this vote in accordance with Chapter 44, Section 20 of the General Laws, thereby reducing the amount authorized to be borrowed to pay such costs by a like amount.

Motion A (Table A) – Capital Equipment & Improvement

Item #	Department	Request Title	Amount	Funding Source
1	Fire	Fire Engine	\$1,300,000	Tax Levy Borrowing
2	Public Works	Multi-Wheel Sander	\$475,000	Tax Levy Borrowing
3	Public Works -Water/Sewer	Sewer Pump Station Rehabilitation and Replacement	\$580,000	Water/Sewer Borrowing
4	Public Works -Water/Sewer	Water Meter Replacement	\$2,000,000	Water/Sewer Borrowing
5	Public Works -Water/Sewer	Water Main Rehabilitation & Replacement	\$3,250,000	Water/Sewer Borrowing
Total			\$1,775,000	Tax Levy Borrowing
Total			\$5,830,000	Water/Sewer Borrowing

Motion A under Article 9 passed by a 2/3rds vote (112/2/0).

Motion B (Requires 2/3rds Vote):

Moved by Cody Jacobs, seconded by Todd Gillenwater that the Town vote to appropriate the sum of \$1,279,000 to be expended as follows:

Under the direction of the Public Works Department for the purpose of:

- Tree Inventory
- Park and Field Renovations

Under the direction of the Community Services Department for the purpose of:

- Playground Updates

Under the direction of the Public Schools for the purpose of:

- Building Router Replacement
- Classroom Audio System

Under the direction of the Police Department for the purpose of:

- Cruiser (2) Replacement

Under the direction of the Facilities Department for the purpose of:

- Mechanical Electrical Plumbing (MEP) Stewardship

all individually shown as items 1 through 7 in Table B below, and that to meet this appropriation the sum of \$1,279,000 be raised from the Capital Stabilization Account.

Motion B (Table B) - Capital Equipment and Improvement

Item #	Department	Request Title	Fall	Funding Source
1	Public Works	Tree Inventory	\$10,000	Capital Stabilization
2	Community Services	Playground Updates	\$35,000	Capital Stabilization
3	Public Works	Park and Field Renovations	\$50,000	Capital Stabilization
4	Public Schools	Building Router Replacement	\$150,000	Capital Stabilization
5	Police	Cruiser (2) Replacement	\$184,000	Capital Stabilization
6	Public Schools	Classroom Audio System	\$200,000	Capital Stabilization
7	Facilities	Mechanical Electrical Plumbing (MEP) Stewardship	\$650,000	Capital Stabilization
Total			\$1,279,000	Capital Stabilization

Motion B under Article 9 passed by a 2/3rds vote (111/3/1).

ARTICLE 12: Amend or Repeal By law Article 27, Information Systems Advisory Board

To see if the Town will vote to amend or repeal Bylaw Article 27, Information Systems Advisory Board; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took the following action:	RECOMMENDATION:	Refer to Sponsor
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	10-2-0
	DATE VOTED:	9/11/2025

MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Referral moved by Cody Jacobs, seconded by Todd Gillenwater.

Motion to repeal by-law Article 27 moved by Rich Sidney and seconded by Bob Awkward.

The motion to refer to sponsor failed (51/53/3).

The positive main motion under Article 12 passed by majority vote (66/40/3).

ARTICLE 11: Amend By law Article 10: Table of Select Board Appointments

To see if the Town will vote to update or amend the table of Select Board Appointments in Bylaw Article 10, Select Board; or otherwise act thereon.

FINANCE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

The Finance Committee took	RECOMMENDATION:	Refer to Sponsor
	QUANTUM OF VOTE:	12-1-0

the following action:	DATE VOTED:	9/30/2025
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MOTION (Requires a Majority Vote)

Moved by Cody Jacobs, seconded by Todd Gillenwater to refer to sponsor.

Favorable action moved by Rich Sidney, seconded by Linda Wolshlager that the Town vote to replace the table entitled “Appointments by the Select Board” in its entirety with the following:

“APPOINTMENTS BY THE SELECT BOARD*"

Name	Citation	Reference	Additional Reference	# of Appointments
Affordable Housing Trust Fund	MGL Ch. 44, Sec. 55C			11
Audit Advisory Committee		B 23A		5
Board of Appeals (ZBA)	MGL Ch. 40A, Sec. 15	C 3-2 (c)	B 29	5
Board of Appeals (ZBA) - Associate Members	MGL Ch. 40A, Sec. 15	C 3-2 (c)	B 29	3
Commission on Disability	MGL Ch. 40, Sec 8J			7
Community Preservation Committee	MGL Ch. 44B. Sec 5			4
Comptroller	MGL Ch. 43C, Sec 11	C 3-2 (c)	C 6-3 (a)	1
Conservation Commission	MGL Ch. 40, Sec. 8C	C 3-2 (c)	B 30	7
Contributory Retirement Board	MGL Ch. 32, Sec. 20(4)(b)			1
Council On Aging	MGL Ch. 40, Sec. 8B	B 25		3 to 11
Director of Veteran's Services	MGL Ch. 115, Sec. 3	C 3-2 (c)		1
Fire Chief	MGL Ch. 48, Sec 42A	C 3-2 (c)	B 24-15	1
Historical Commission	MGL Ch. 40, Sec. 8D			7
Historic District Commission	MGL Ch. 40C, Sec. 4	B 26		7
Historic District Commission - Alternates	MGL Ch. 40C, Sec. 4	B 26		3
Lock-up Keeper	MGL Ch. 40, Sec. 35			1

Natick Cultural Council	MGL Ch. 10, Sec. 58			9
Open Space Advisory Committee		B 32		7
Parking Clerk	MGL Ch. 90, Sec. 20A			1
Police Chief	MGL Ch. 41, Sec. 97	C 3-2 (c)	B 24-14	1
Recreation and Parks Commission	MGL Ch. 41, Sec. 2	C 3-12 (a)		4
Registrars of Voters	MGL Ch. 51, Sec. 15	C 3-2 (c)	B 28	3
Town Administrator	MGL Ch. 41, Sec. 23A	C 3-2 (c)		1
Town Clerk	MGL Ch. 41, Sec. 1 MGL Ch. 41, Sec. 1B	C 6-5 (a)		**
Town Counsel		C 3-2 (c)		1
Treasurer – Collector	MGL Ch. 41, Sec. 1 MGL Ch. 41, Sec. 1B	C 6-4 (a)		**
Veterans Burial Officer	MGL Ch. 115. Sec. 9			1

* The Select Board is the appointing authority for these boards, committees, and agencies under general law, Natick Home Rule Charter, or Bylaw

** The Select Board confirms the appointment made by the Town Administrator

C=Charter

B=Bylaw

REGIONAL BOARD APPOINTMENTS BY THE SELECT BOARD

Name	Citation	# of Appointments
MBTA Advisory Board	MGL Ch. 161A, Sec. 74, as amended by Ch. 29 of the Acts of 2021	1
Metropolitan Area Planning Council	MGL Ch.40B, Sec. 24	2
MetroWest Regional Transportation Authority	MGL Ch. 161B, Sec. 3 and Ch. 25 of the Acts of 2009	1
MWRA Advisory Board	Ch. 372 of the Acts of 1984, Sec. 23.	1

South Middlesex Regional Vocational School (Keefe Tech)	Agreement Between the Towns of Ashland, Framingham, Holliston, Hopkinton, and Natick, Massachusetts, dated December 5, 1966, as amended.	2
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The motion to refer to sponsor failed (24/68/2).

The main motion under Article 11 passed by majority vote (66/40/3).

A motion was made by Rich Sidney and seconded by Josh Ostroff to adjourn. The meeting adjourned at 10:26 until Thursday, October 23 at 7:30 PM.

A record of the First Session of
2025 Fall Annual Town Meeting
October 21, 2025

Andrew Ghobrial, Town Clerk